The next step was a move through Belgium, as the president of the Security Council, to establish a three-nation commission. In that process, India's main request that Pakistan refrain from assisting the invaders was conveniently dropped. The further sleight of hand happened when the title of the resolution itself was changed from 'Jammu & Kashmir Question' to the 'India–Pakistan Question'. Canada took over from Belgium and carried the Western agenda forward by pressing for a Pakistani military presence in place of the invaders if they withdrew. Matters reached a stage where India threatened to leave the Commonwealth in protest against such bias.

As the stakes rose higher, the US and other Western allies also got drawn deeper into the game. Intense pressures were exerted over the next few years, including the threat to withhold assistance to India. The turning point, of course, was a 1957 UK–US draft resolution that ended up being vetoed by the USSR.

India's defeat in the 1962 conflict with China saw a renewal of such efforts in the next decade. The Harriman-Sandys Mission of 1963 that sought to arbitrate on Jammu & Kashmir was the most serious of these endeavours. If they failed, it was less due to intent and more because of global circumstances and India's resistance. The illegal 1963 China–Pakistan agreement on Shaksgam Valley made it awkward for Western nations to make common cause with Pakistan beyond a point. But by 1965, Western partiality for Pakistan reasserted itself through their efforts on suppressing its responsibility for initiating the conflict.

Although this issue moved purely to the bilateral format as a result of the Shimla Agreement of 1972, attempts to interfere in Jammu & Kashmir nevertheless continued. This happened publicly during the Clinton Administration. Even the reaction of Western powers to our 1998 nuclear tests tried to link it to this issue. While the Bush Administration moderated this somewhat, there were nevertheless conversations behind closed doors. Barack Obama also brought up Kashmir during his presidential campaign and there was a debate about the US Ambassador Richard Holbrooke's remit that bears recalling.

Such diplomatic endeavours aside, what has hurt our interests more are the actual violations of sovereignty and territorial integrity by China. It began in 1963 and kept increasing through connectivity projects that later developed into the so-called CPEC. Each of these efforts has been countered and will continue to be so. But keeping all this in mind, we must